

Also—and this was far from the least of the considerations which decided me—I felt that, in our contemporary society, far too much emphasis was being placed on *getting* rich, on amassing wealth. Little if any attention was being paid to the very important question of *how to be rich*, how to discharge the responsibilities created by wealth even while constructively enjoying the privileges and prerogatives conferred by it.

After all, "richness" is at least as much a matter of character, of philosophy, outlook and attitude, as it is of money.

The "millionaire mentality" is not—and in this day and age, cannot be—merely an accumulative mentality. The able, ambitious man who strives for success must understand that the term "rich" has infinite shadings of meaning. In order to justify himself and his wealth, he must know *how to be rich* in virtually every positive sense of the term.

These factors—and some others—all contributed to my final decision to accede to the editors' request.

I might add that **PLAYBOY'S** Editor-Publisher, Hugh M.

Hefner, and the magazine's Editorial Director, A. C.

Spectorsky, promised that I would be granted *carte blanche* to say what I wanted, regardless of how unconventional, nonconformist or controversial my views happened to be.

They have kept this promise faithfully through the ensuing years—but I am getting ahead of myself.

"I will prepare the first piece, and then we'll see," I said, in effect.

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The results, to say the least, were surprising to me. Although what I have written is unconventional, even icono-clastic, the response has been overwhelmingly favorable.